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MGP 2026 - Ethics - 914220 (code) → HLT

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Q1) a) Corruption has been the deadly parasite that is strangling the health of our society from times immemorial as such every ethical treatise tries to address it right from chanakya's times to modern day polity yet it still pervades.

@ people continue to engage with it due to following reasons and powers

> unbridled discretion × without accountability facilitates corruption

> personal pecuniary gains and selfish ego-centricness over longer social good w/a view to amass wealth out of greed

> Institutionalised and systematic corruption that co-opts people

> value system and morality of the individual that provides breeding ground for corruption

> Not enough monetary incentive on par with other organisation (or) corporate which provides a baseline for good quality of life

> social and public condonment of corruption at large that reinforces institutionalisation.

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Significance of value system in fighting corruption

1) provides for conscience build up that can push the corruption tendencies

2) public disapproval and moral scrutiny provides necessary ~~force~~ force to act ethically

3) cognitive dissonance and fear of ~~ethical~~ disrespect ~~and god if religious~~ role modelling values are cultivated

4) Fear of god, and a way of life can be provided if religious values are cultivated

Thus as remarked by 2nd ARC that "~~the~~ Gandhi's vision of prosperous and strong India - swaraj can never become reality if we don't address the stranglehold of corruption on our polity".

—o— —o— —o— —o—

b) The statement captures the basic tension between Right to know and Right to privacy that must be balanced for smooth functioning of our polity & society that touches upon transparency, integrity, self preservation and utilitarian principles.

Right to information should be absolute.

1) It constitute the ethical value of transparent, public confidence building measure and democratic values

such as participation, inclusiveness, informed decision making etc.,

Eg:- Voters right to know precedents of the Leaders in fair trail

2) Acts as a necessary ingredient for making informed and right decisions

3) Public scrutiny and social auditing can be promoted that can nudge erring officials to act right

4) promotes and reinforces social contract confidence and faith of public towards government functioning

5) Recourse to grievance redressal if the functioning is not upto the expectations

Right to privacy and secrecy triumphs the RTI

① Fundamental right of citizenery to not disclose certain details they deem constitute private

2) National sovereignity and integrity issues in times of turmoil

3) Fight against anarchist and evil forces to preserve social cohesion and harmony

4) smooth functioning of government machinery and administration

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5) Legal and international ~~con~~ diplomatic constraints neccessiates secrecy and private dealing of various matters

Thus, we need to find the golden mean between these two extremes as propounded by aristotle to achieve eudemonia.

Q2) a) Corporate governance refers to the management private non-governmental entities that are established to provide goods and services which have larger public and societal implications in terms of employment and provisions

Corporate governance core principles

1) Transparency and disclosure of all proceedings and developments to all stakeholders and independent audit mechanism

2) Risk management and delivering performance

3) Inclusiveness and maintaining diversity to deliver on the promises of distributive justice

4) Board of directors and hierarchial management in order to establish the accountability and responsibility

5) sustanability, intergenerational equity and ecological & environmental semblance

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in order to uphold utilitarian and deontological principles

5) vision, policy framework and standard service delivery agreement in order to provide for objectiveness and fairness in proceedings

Laws enacted by government to promote ethical corporate governance

① Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2020 to provide smooth and just exit of ailing firms

2) The company Act 2013 provides for independent directors, independent audit and CSR

3) SEBI (Listings and obligations disclosure) order 2015 to provide transparency and objectiveness

4) RBI and IDBI obligations to impose certain stricter norms

As remarked by Gandhi that commerce without morality is a sin, the corporate governance needs to act inethically & morally in order to provide freedom & fairness

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(b) The ongoing Israel-Hamas highlights the devastations and rampant ravages of war and conflict have on humanity and collective conscience of humans which failed to ensure peace in the world.

Ethical issue to be considered in launching and continuing the conflict:-

① Low or proportional response with as minimal civilian collateral damage as possible.

② Balancing between Jus ad bellum Jus in bello ethics that can ensure right means to legitimate ends.

③ upholding utilitarian principle rather than unilaterally taking decisions and actions as such to uphold cosmopolitanism

④ Real politik principle in consonance with idealism to promote principles of empathy, justice, fairness and equity in conflict

⑤ Resorting to diplomacy and dialogue whenever feasible to stop perpetuating violence and conflict in order to establish rule of law and international rules based conduct

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Ethical issues involved in given state affairs

1) Assymmetric war balance and large scale collateral civilian damage with narrow unilateral decision making. and human rights violation.
   Ex: Israel calling for complete annihilation of west Bank and Lebanon.

2) Spill over into adjacent area making the region unstable jeopardising the life of common citizen.
   Ex: Extending war into Iran and assassination of its supreme leader

3) Failure of international dialogue diplomacy UN and rules & based order & law to stop the war in order to ensure peace and stability.

The perpetuation of war reflects collective failure of humanity to nations as well as Gandhian principle of non-violence and truth while maintaining the fine balance between Real politik and idealism to promote "Vasudhaika kutumbh" principle.

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3) a) > probity refers to the quality of having strong morals, principles, upright behaviour and complete honesty that must be above scrutiny and reproach.

> The quote capture essential keystone of the structure of public administration based on a tacit social contract.

Probity not just a virtue but foundation of public administration:-

1) Enhances public trust, confidence and faith of public in administration which strikes at the core of it.

Eg:- TN seshan's stint as a CEC is synonymous to honesty, integrity and fairness for public

2) Invokes ethos of constitutionalism, democratic principles and collective decision making that upholds utilitarianism whilst limiting tyranny of majority

Eg:- Jayashant Nair (Kerala cadre IAS) introduced "collector Bro" campaign that showed the power of crowd sourced strength

democratic principles,

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Eg:- E. Sreedharan as an ~~head~~ incharge of konkan railways project that become an engineering marvel.

4) Reinforcing principles of integrity, empathy, justice, equity and fairness in the lives of public administrators that can reduce cognitive dissonance whilst providing consistency and coherency in character and conscience

Eg:- APJ Abdul Kalam making sure he is piling on any wealth and material assests for himself.

5) performance evaluation of government as ~~well~~ public administration are seen as face of government as such to promote stability, social order and peace in society one ought to act with probity.

Eg:-

Thus probity is not only a personal virtue rather a key ingredient of a good governance in order to establish the utopian India Gandhi envisioned for as in "Su-raj"

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b) Work culture refers to shared set of beliefs, customs, values, behaviours and principles that characterises an institution or organisation as well as what they stood for in the society

Measures I would adopt to promote value based and compliance based work culture

1) Formulating customer charters, service level agreement objectives as well as standard operating procedure documents to ensure objectivity, integrity and a codified version of authorisation eg principles source eg

2) Encouraging collaboration among diverse, groups on basis of gender, caste, ethnicity, race etc, to promote harmony and empathy shared

3) Internal accountable mechanism as well as redressal mechanism for any delinquency

4) Mid career training and treatment workshops and official events to sensitize employees.

5) 'principle-focused leadership as well as robust, equitable and fair resource allocation

6) Rewarding ethical work and focusing on learning over punishment in an organisation set up

7) Dual code of ethics with principles that must be legally complied for whilst listing aspirational principles that we must strive for (aspirational values)

8) Linking metrics to work culture in order to cultivate objectivity and transparency

9) Interactive learning & collaboration and accessible redressal mechanism and clear framework

Thus work culture must be ethically sound in order to provide for just means to a right ends as elucidated by one of the sins of Gandhian ethos is "work without morals" is a sin.

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a) This case provides the interplay between commercial, reputational and public relations with personal morality, freedom of expression & speech as well as artistic freedom being gauged upon in the age of information and social media

(a) Ethical issues involved

1) Artistic freedom and expression while respecting sentiment and sensitive issues of society

2) Rewarding meritocracy over yielding to public pressure and tyranny of majority in order to ensure commercial interest do not triumphs ethical principles

3) Rule of law, accountability and equity in social discourse.

4) Credibility and reputation of organisation that must be maintained for survivability

5) Issues of shared responsibility and ethics of transparency and professionalism to establish good governance and work culture

suitable course of action):-

withdrawing the advertisement and issuing an apology and modifying sensitively whilst taking recourse to legal measures to punish those who defamed and made threat calls to him while backing the Nisha for her creativity and capability as directed to his company. This would ensure:

1) Immediate damage control of company reputation and credibility

2) commercial interests upholded

3) Avoiding personal safety issues and psychological & emotional stress

4) supporting independent thinking and creative freedom

5) Establishes his leadership credibility in as well as shared responsibility

(b) In the age of social media, every attempt is being made to stifle the freedom of voice and expression.

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"censorship by

that actively translates to "~~cen~~ ~~social~~ ~~censorship~~". Their motivation can be said as bullying". to be stemmed ~~from~~ below.

1) ~~Anonymity~~ and ~~solution~~ large scale reach without any accountability and punishment

2) principle x "Harbours safe heaven" for social media platforms that perpetuate the inaction

3) Algorithmic design and systematic engagement ~~to~~ ~~engage~~ with inflammatory and ~~final~~ narrow content than balanced ~~and~~ views.

4) Ideological and institutionalised funding for propaganda that can sub-liminally thought shape other users

5) Reinforcement and enticement from ranting echo chambers making users to resort to extremes

~~of~~ ~~of tools of~~ social

Thus moderating and infusing ethical discourses as well as sensitising users to perils of misinformation, thought shaping information as well as use of social media is the need of the hour

weak

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5) This case represents various principles of ethical public administration as in empathy, equity, distributive fairness, justice and fairness to uphold the rights of tribals, whose natural ways of living is being destroyed for larger public good.

My approach to the problem

1) Engaging with tribals & their representatives and getting to know their full demands benefits out of project

2) Auditing and estimating the approximate damage to their livelihoods in terms of economy, socially, psychologically and physiological to provide for multidimensional analysis of issue at hand.

3) Maintaining transparency and open communication with all stakeholders in order to build their confidence and trust in the process

4) seeking ways to upskill and with marketable skills as well as providing for incentives & community development

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projects for them in order to provide for long term rehabilitation

5) Documenting the process and providing for paper trail in order to enhance systematic approach and raison d'être for policy decisions.

Main elements to be included in the policy

1) Legally binding package agreement with clear incentives, responsibilities and legal redressal meanisms.

2) Establishing fairness, equitability and distributive justic as core ideals & policies to be included in while dealing the matter

3) Clear step by step plan to make them equipped with marketable skills as well as working out some reservation.

4) A monitoring task force for co-ordinating and watch out for development of the adivasi community being displaced

"development without equity is asin"

As remarke by Gandhi we should make sure that benefits of dev are repeat to everyone equitably